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THE SOCIAL STRATEGY PLAYBOOK



A Content System You'll Actually Use

BY MK PARRISH • \$38

WHAT THIS IS

Most people don't have a content problem. They have a system problem. They post when they feel like it, the posts don't sound like them, and the whole thing collapses the first busy week. Consistency feels like willpower, so it never lasts.

This is the strategy side of The Social Suite — my managed content service — taken apart and handed to you so you can run it yourself, at your own pace, without a retainer. It's the exact thinking I use to onboard a new client, written out so you can do it alone.

It's a system, not a mood board. By the end you'll have your pillars, your voice, a month of content planned, and a posting rhythm that survives a bad week. Work through it in order. Fill in every template as you go — reading it does nothing; *using* it is the product.

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You will not out-discipline a bad system. Build the system once and let it carry the weeks your motivation doesn't show up.

SECTION ONE: BEFORE YOU POST ANYTHING

You can't make content that sounds like you until you've decided what "you" sounds like and who it's for. Two one-page tools do that. Don't skip to the tactics — every tactic later points back here.

The Authority Brief

Answer these five in writing. One specific person, real sentences, no hedging. Every post you ever make will be traceable to one of these answers.

1. **Who is this for?** One person, named specifically — "Dana, a second-time founder who just raised a seed round and feels invisible next to louder competitors," not "founders."
2. **What do you want to be known for, in one sentence?** If it takes two, keep cutting.
3. **What do you believe about your field that most people in it won't say out loud?** This is the seed of every post that travels.
4. **What does this person need to believe before they'll trust you?**
5. **What's the one action you want to be top-of-mind for when they're ready?**

Worked example (a fractional CMO):

For: Dana, post-seed founder, technical, allergic to hype. Known for: making early-stage marketing feel like engineering, not magic. Unsaid belief: most "growth hacks" are noise that buries the one channel that actually works. Needs to believe: marketing can be rigorous, not vibes. One action: "call her when it's time to build the real engine."

If you can't fill this in, more posting won't help. Clarity first.

The Voice Snapshot

Three adjectives. Three banned words. One "sounds like me" sentence. This is the guardrail that keeps you from sliding into generic industry filler the second you're tired.

Fill-in: *My voice is _____, _____, and _____ (e.g., dry, exact, warm). I never say _____, _____, or _____ (e.g., "leverage," "passionate about," "game-changer"). When I sound most like myself, I write sentences like: " _____."*

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Pin the snapshot above your drafting doc. Nine out of ten off-brand posts die the moment they're read against that one sentence.

SECTION TWO: THE CONTENT PILLAR FRAMEWORK

The single highest-leverage decision you'll make: three to five **content pillars** — the themes you return to on purpose. Pillars are why people follow you *for a reason* instead of scrolling past. Pick from these five:

- **The expertise pillar** — what you know cold; the thing people already DM you about.
- **The point-of-view pillar** — what you believe that's a little contrarian. This builds authority, not just reach.
- **The proof pillar** — results, process, the work itself. Shown, not claimed.
- **The human pillar** — the story, the why. This builds trust.
- **The fifth (optional)** — seasonal, community, or behind-the-scenes.

For each pillar, define three things: the *core promise* (what the reader gets), three to five *recurring angles*, and a few *example hooks*. Five pillars × four angles = twenty post ideas before you've tried.

Worked example — the "point-of-view" pillar for the fractional CMO:

- **Core promise:** I'll tell you which marketing advice to ignore.
- **Angles:** sacred cows that waste budget · metrics that lie · "best practices" that are just averages · the channel everyone skips.
- **Example hooks:** "Your CAC isn't a budget problem. It's a positioning problem." / "Most founders A/B test the button color and never test the offer." / "Brand awareness is what agencies sell when they can't sell revenue."

Do this for all your pillars in the **Content Pillar Map** template. That map is your idea bank for the rest of the year.

SECTION THREE: BRAND VOICE, CALIBRATED BY PLATFORM

Your voice is one thing; how it *lands* changes by room. The same idea is a carousel on Instagram, a short essay on LinkedIn, and a spoken hook on TikTok. Getting the translation right is the difference between content that travels and content that sits.

PLATFORM	TO NE	LENGTH	HOOK STYLE	THE ONE MISTAKE TO AVOID
LinkedIn	Credible, plain	120–200 words	First two lines = the whole game; promise a payoff	Sounding like a motivational poster
Instagram	Warm, visual-first	Caption serves the image	First line must survive the "...more" cut	Burying the point below the fold
TikTok / Reels	Spoken, fast	30–60 sec script	Three-second verbal hook	Writing for the eye, not the ear

LinkedIn hook → payoff frame: open with tension ("Most founders price from fear."), widen it ("Here's what that costs you over a year..."), pay it off with one concrete idea, end with a line they'd repost.

Instagram first-line swipes: "Save this before your next launch." / "The bio mistake I see every single week." / "Read this if your content feels like everyone else's."

TikTok three-second hooks: "Stop writing your About page like this." / "The fastest way to sound generic online." / "I rewrote this founder's bio in 60 seconds — watch."

SECTION FOUR: THE 30-DAY CONTENT SPRINT

The same structure I use to onboard Social Suite clients. A month of content, planned and batched, so posting becomes *execution* instead of invention.

The sprint calendar. Map 30 days across your pillars so no theme dominates and nothing repeats too soon. A simple, sane weekly pattern:

DAY	PILLAR	FORMAT
Mon	Point-of-view	LinkedIn short essay
Wed	Expertise	Carousel / how-to
Fri	Proof or Human	Story or case
(1x/wk)	Any	Repurpose to Reel

The batch workflow — a month in two sittings. *Sitting one (ideation):* pull 12–16 ideas straight from your Pillar Map; write only the hooks. *Sitting two (production):* draft all the posts from the hooks, back to back. Separating ideation from production is the whole trick — you stop starting from a blank page.

The caption structure (fill-in): **Hook** ("_____") → **Context** (2–3 lines of the why) → **Payoff** (the one useful idea) → **CTA** ("Save this / follow for more / DM me 'X'"). Starters: "Here's what nobody tells you about ____." · "I used to believe _____. Then _____." · "The fastest way to ____ is _____."

The repurposing map. One strong idea → a LinkedIn post (the argument) → an Instagram carousel (the steps) → a Reel (the hook, spoken). Same spine, three rooms. You're not repeating yourself; you're meeting the same person in different places.

SECTION FIVE: THE POSTING SYSTEM

A system you keep beats a strategy you admire. Here's how the whole thing runs without depending on motivation.

- **The weekly rhythm.** Pick a cadence you can hit on your worst week, not your best. Three real posts beat seven you resent. When life happens, drop frequency before quality, and drop the platform you like least first.
- **The content bank.** Keep a backlog of 5–10 ready-to-post pieces. A bank is what makes a bad week a non-event instead of a broken streak.
- **The review loop.** Watch three numbers only: saves/shares (did it land?), profile visits (did it pull?), and DMs/replies (did it start something?). Ignore raw likes and follower count week to week — they're weather.
- **The recovery plan.** You will fall off. When you do: post one thing from the bank, say nothing about being gone, and resume the rhythm. No apology posts. Falling off and getting back on *is* the system working as designed.

“*Consistency isn't a personality trait. It's a backlog plus a rhythm plus permission to restart without shame.*”

THE TEMPLATES (AND HOW TO USE THEM)

Each lives as a Google Doc you copy to your Drive — but the frameworks above *are* the templates, ready to rebuild anywhere: the **Authority Brief** (5 questions), the **Voice Snapshot**, the **Content Pillar Map** (promise · angles · hooks), the **Platform Calibration tables**, the **30-Day Sprint Calendar**, the **Caption Structure** (hook → context → payoff → CTA), and the **Posting Tracker + Content Bank**. Fill them with your real answers. The structure is the gift; the words have to be yours.

KEEP GOING

This is the self-guided companion to **The Social Suite** — my managed strategy, writing, and execution service. If you'd rather hand the system to someone who runs it every day, that's the service.

If your *voice* is the part that keeps going generic, **The Brand Voice Playbook** is the system underneath all of this. And if you want the positioning the pillars hang on, start with the free **Positioning Checklist** at mkparrish.com.

You don't need to post more. You need a system that posts *you*. Now you have one.

— MK Parrish

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